

Saleem Shah

Department of Economics
Clark University, Worcester, MA, USA

Email: salshah@clarku.edu
Website: sites.google.com/view/saleemshah

Education

Clark University, Worcester, MA
Ph.D. in Economics (Expected 2026)
M.A. in Economics, 2021–2023

Institute of Management Sciences, Peshawar, Pakistan
Master of Science in Economics, *Gold Medalist*, 2017–2019
Bachelor of Science in Economics, *Silver Medalist*, 2012–2017

Research Interests

Applied Microeconomics, History of Economic Development , and Economics of Gender

Working Papers

- Immunity Through Ages: The Role of Variolation in Shaping the Use of Modern Vaccines—Evidence from Africa
- Breaking the Cycle: The Effects of Child-Marriage Legislation on Child Marriages and the Next Generation’s Health
- Public Health Insurance and Maternal–Child Health
- The Influence of Climate Variability on Child Marriages and Child Health—Evidence from Pakistan

Awards and Honors

- 2025: Mentee, Association for Mentorship and Inclusion in Economics (AMIE)
- 2025: Diversity Scholar, American Society of Health Economists
- 2025: Conference Travel Grant, Department of Economics, Clark University
- 2024: Veendorp Prize, Best Research Poster, Clark University

- 2024: Graduate Student Paper Award, Northeast Business and Economics Association
- 2024: Research Skills Development Grant, Graduate Students Council, Clark University
- 2023: WISE Fellow, Massachusetts
- 2020: Fulbright Scholarship (Ph.D. in Economics)
- 2020: HEC-DAAD Scholarship for Ph.D. in Economics (declined)
- 2020: HEC Indigenous Scholarship for Ph.D. in Economics (declined)
- 2019: Gold Medal, M.S. Economics, IMSciences
- 2017: Silver Medal, B.S. Economics, IMSciences
- 2016: Second Position, National Shadow Budget Competition
- 2012: HEC Scholarship for BSc(Hons) in Economics
- 2011: Stoori Da Pakhtunkhwa Award, Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

Research Grants

- 2023: WISE Fellows Grant, Worcester State University (\$6,800)
- 2021: NRPU–HEC Grant: Impact Evaluation of the Sehat Sahulat Program (9.3 million PKR $\approx$ 33,000), Co-PI

Pre-Doctoral Publications

- Shah, S., Khan, I. H., & Mehboob, G. R. (2020). Catastrophic health expenditures in Pakistan. *Pakistan Journal of Economic Studies*, 3(1), 87–104.
- Mehboob, S., Mohammad, N., Abbas, M., & Shah, S. (2020). Relationship between clinical indications and endoscopic findings. *Medico Research Chronicles*.
- Mehboob, G., Hassan, A., & Shah, S. (2018). Community intervention assessment. *Journal of Development Policy Research & Practice*, 106–119.
- Shah, S., Khan, I. H., & Khan, A. (2021). Asset price channel of monetary policy. *Global Economics Review*, VI, 86–93.

Resting Projects

- Colonial Administrative Systems and Human-Capital Formation in Pakistan: Insights from Demographic Surveys and Nightlights Data

- Direct and Spillover Effects of Access to Higher Education, Evidence from Higher Education Scholarship Program in Pakistan
- Insurgency Exposure and Birth Spacing, Evidence from Pakistan

Conference Presentations

- 2025: Immunity Through Ages: The Role of Variolation in Shaping Use of Modern Vaccines, Economic History Association (Poster)
- 2025: Participation in 14th Annual Conference of ASHEcon as Diversity Scholar
- 2025: Invited Discussant to the Child and Infant Health program for the ASHEcon 2025 Conference
- 2025: Weathering the Future: Climate Variability and Child Marriages, 22nd Annual Multidisciplinary Conference, Clark University
- 2024: Weathering the Future: Climate Variability and Child Marriages, Eastern Economic Association
- 2024: Weathering the Future: Climate Variability and Child Marriages, Northeast Business & Economics Association
- 2020: Evaluation of Prime Minister National Health Program in Pakistan, SZABIST International Conference, Karachi
- 2018: Catastrophic Expenditures in District Chitral, 9th Public Health Conference, Health Services Academy, Islamabad
- 2016: Catastrophic Expenditures in Tehsil Utman Khel, 7th Public Health Conference, Health Services Academy, Islamabad

Short Courses and Trainings

- 2025: PhD Course on Social Protection (BREAD-IGC)
- 2024: PhD Course on Urban Economics for Developing Countries (BREAD-IGC)
- 2024: Spatial Analysis (ESRI)
- 2023: PhD Course on Environmental Economics (BREAD-IGC)
- 2021: Academic Writing (Michigan State University)
- Online Teaching and Class Management (NAHE)
- Questionnaire Development (UNDP, Pakistan)

Computational Skills

STATA, R, ArcGIS, Geoda, Matlab, Microsoft Office

Language

English (Professional), Urdu (Professional), Pashto (Native), Arabic (Basic)

Talks

- 2026: St. Olaf College (invited lecture), Institute of Management Sciences Peshawar (invited lecture)–expected
- 2025: Shared Scholarship Research Seminar, Worcester State University
- 2019: Social Capital for Sustainable Development, Microaccess Program (Funded by US State Department), University of Buner, FATA University

Selected Media Coverage

- 2022: The Road to Ph.D., from Tree School in Bajaur, Kafekaam [Video link](#)
- 2023: Journey of a Fulbrighter, Voice of America (Pashto) [Video link](#)
- 2020: Covid-19 Challenge for a Community Member, Pakistan Outlook [Article link](#)

Work Experience

- Adjunct Professor, Worcester State University (Fall 2025, Spring 2026)
Course: Principles of Microeconomics
- Research Assistant, Clark University-Summer (2022–2025)
- Peer Learning Assistant for Macroeconomics Growth, Clark University (Spring 2023)
- Lecturer, University of Buner (2019–2021)
Courses: Intro to Economics, Principles of Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Mathematical Economics, Development Economics, Statistics, Introduction to Econometrics
- Visiting Lecturer, FATA University (2019–2021)
Courses: Introduction to Economics, Macroeconomics, Economy of Pakistan
- Lecturer, Government Degree College Hayatabad (2017–2018)
Courses: Intro to Economics, Intermediate Microeconomics

- Research Associate, Center for Public Policy Research, IMSciences (2017–2019)
Responsibilities: Coordination with Research Teams, Questionnaire Development, Data Analysis, Report Writing

Professional Memberships

American Society of Health Economics, Economics History Association

Dissertation Committee

Chair: Jon Denton Schneider (Clark University)

Members: Magda Tsaneva; Wayne Gray